

NEWS AND MORE

Through Network18, RIL also has a significant play in the news space

► **In addition to** entertainment, Reliance Industries Ltd (RIL) has a significant play in news. This is through its ownership of Network18 Media & Investments, a listed entity with a presence across television, publishing, and digital media. Independent

Media Trust (IMT), whose sole beneficiary is RIL and other promoter group entities, in all holds close to 57% in Network18.

A report by rating agency ICRA in October states that the company “has a strong and diversified presence across me-

dia segments including television, publishing, and digital media and is one of the largest assets of the RIL group in the media and entertainment segment”. Its news channels are across languages and the digital businesses include News18.com, Moneycontrol, Firstpost and cnbctv18.com (see table below).

RIL, through IMT, had acquired majority control of Network18 in May 2014. Two years earlier, IMT had funded the then Raghav Bahl-owned network to buy out Hyderabad-based Eenadu TV from Ramoji Rao. The deal with Eenadu gave it full control over the non-Telugu news channels business and a small stake in Eenadu Telugu.

TV18, a subsidiary of Network18—it holds 51.17%, according to a CareEdge report

published in September—now operates 62 channels spanning news and entertainment. The former includes CNN News18, CNBC TV18, News18 India in Hindi general news and 14 regional channels, including the News18-Lokmat joint venture. The entertainment piece is through a 13.54% holding in Viacom18, that in turn holds close to 47% in the Reliance-Disney JV. The largest shareholder in Viacom18 is RIL (see graphic ‘Viacom Pride’).

For FY24, Network18 had a total operating income of just under ₹9,300 crore, up 50% from FY23. The company holds a 50% stake in India Cast Media Distribution, with the other 50% held by Viacom18, a business focussed on content asset monetisation.

—**Krishna Gopalan**

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RIL-VIACOM18-STAR INDIA JV

TV18

News

1. News18 India
2. CNBC Awaaz
3. News18 Rajasthan
4. News18 Uttar Pradesh
5. News18 Bihar
6. CNN News18
7. CNBC TV18
8. News18 Assam
9. News18 Bangla
10. News18 Gujarati
11. CNBC Bajar
12. News18 Lokmat
13. News18 Odia
14. News18 Urdu
15. News18 Kannada
16. News18 Kerala
17. News18 Tamil Nadu
18. News18 Jammu

Network18

i) All entertainment, sports and news channels of Viacom18 and TV18

ii) Digital Content

Moneycontrol
Firstpost
News18.com
CNBCTV18.com
Topper Learning

iii) Digital Commerce

BookMyShow

iv) Publishing

Overdrive
Forbes
Better Photography

v) Motion Pictures

Viacom18 Studio

vi) Distribution

India Cast Media Distribution

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